

2026 US Import Tariff Guide

The Complete Reference for Importers,
FBA Sellers, and E-Commerce Businesses

Everything you need to navigate the most complex
US tariff environment in over a century.

USTariffCalc.com
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Chapter 1

The 2026 Tariff Landscape: What Changed and Why

The US import tariff system in 2026 is the most complex it has been in over a century. To understand where we are, you need to understand how we got here.

The IEEPA Era (April 2025 - February 2026)

In April 2025, President Trump used the International Emergency Economic Powers Act (IEEPA) to impose sweeping "reciprocal" tariffs on imports from virtually every country. Rates ranged from 10% (baseline) to 145% (China). This was unprecedented: IEEPA had never been used for trade tariffs before.

These tariffs immediately disrupted global supply chains. Importers faced overnight cost increases of 20-145% depending on their sourcing country. Many businesses were forced to raise prices, absorb losses, or scramble to find alternative suppliers.

The Supreme Court Ruling (February 20, 2026)

The Supreme Court ruled that IEEPA could not be used to impose import tariffs, immediately invalidating approximately \$175 billion in collected duties. This created a legal vacuum: the tariffs were gone, but the administration still wanted protection for domestic industries.

The Section 122 Response (February 24, 2026)

Within four days, the administration imposed a new 15% global surcharge under Section 122 of the Trade Act of 1974. This rarely-used emergency provision allows tariffs of up to 15% for a maximum of 150 days without Congressional approval. It was the fastest available legal tool.

Key Point: Section 122 tariffs expire on July 24, 2026. This is the hard deadline. The President cannot extend them without Congress. What happens after July 24 is one of the biggest questions in international trade right now.

Where We Are Now

The result is an unprecedented four-layer tariff system where multiple programs operate simultaneously. A single import can face MFN base duties, Section 122 surcharges, Section 301 tariffs (for Chinese goods), and Section 232 tariffs (for specific sectors like steel and aluminum) all stacked on top of each other.

This guide breaks down each layer, shows you exactly how they interact, and gives you the tools and strategies to minimize your exposure.

Chapter 2

The Four Tariff Layers Explained

Layer 1: MFN Base Duty (0-48%)

Most Favored Nation (MFN) rates are the baseline tariffs that apply to all US imports. These rates are set by Congress and codified in the Harmonized Tariff Schedule (HTS). Every product has a specific 10-digit HTS code that determines its MFN rate.

MFN rates vary enormously by product: electronics typically face 0-5%, clothing 10-32%, footwear 8-48%, and agricultural products 0-25%. The rate depends on the exact product, not the country of origin.

Layer 2: Section 122 Global Surcharge (15%)

The 15% Section 122 surcharge applies to nearly all imports regardless of country. There are two important exemptions: products covered by Section 232 (steel, aluminum, automobiles, semiconductors, copper) are exempt from Section 122, and USMCA-qualifying goods from Mexico and Canada are also exempt.

Critical Exemption: If your product falls under Section 232 or qualifies under USMCA, you do NOT pay the 15% Section 122 surcharge. This exemption saves thousands of dollars per shipment and is frequently overlooked.

Layer 3: Section 301 (China Only, 7.5-100%)

Section 301 tariffs apply exclusively to Chinese goods. These were originally imposed in 2018-2019 during the US-China trade war and have been maintained and expanded since. Rates vary by product list: most consumer goods face 25%, some products on List 4A face 7.5%, electric vehicles face 100%, solar products and semiconductors face 50%.

Layer 4: Section 232 (Sector-Specific, 25-50%)

Section 232 tariffs target specific industrial sectors deemed critical to national security. Steel and aluminum face 50% (25% for UK), automobiles face 25%, and semiconductors and copper face 25%. These rates apply regardless of country of origin, though some exceptions exist for trade agreement partners.

How the Layers Stack

Product	MFN	S122	S301	S232	Total
Electronics (China)	2.5%	15%	25%	0%	42.5%
Clothing (China)	18%	15%	25%	0%	58%
Electronics (Vietnam)	2.5%	15%	0%	0%	17.5%
Electronics (Mexico USMCA)	2.5%	0%	0%	0%	2.5%
Steel (Any Country)	3%	0%*	25%**	50%	78%
Autos (Any Country)	2.5%	0%*	0%	25%	27.5%

**Section 232 products are exempt from Section 122. **Chinese steel faces Section 301 on top.*

Chapter 3

Tariff Rates by Country: Complete Reference

The following table shows the tariff layers applicable to each major US trading partner. Rates shown are for non-Section 232 products.

Country	Section 122	Section 301	Typical Total*
China	15%	7.5-100%	27-72%+
Vietnam	15%	0%	15-33%
India	15%	0%	15-33%
Thailand	15%	0%	15-33%
Indonesia	15%	0%	15-33%
Bangladesh	15%	0%	15-47%
Taiwan	15%	0%	15-33%
Japan	15%	0%	15-33%
South Korea	15%	0%	15-33%
EU Countries	15%	0%	15-33%
United Kingdom	15%	0%	15-33%
Mexico (USMCA)	0%	0%	0-18%
Canada (USMCA)	0%	0%	0-18%
Brazil	15%	0%	15-33%

**Total includes MFN base duty which varies by product. Section 232 products (steel, aluminum, autos) have separate rates.*

Key Observations

USMCA is the clear winner. Mexico and Canada under USMCA face zero Section 122 and zero Section 301 tariffs. For qualifying goods, only the MFN base rate applies, which is often 0-5%.

China faces the heaviest burden. With Section 301 tariffs of 25-100% on top of Section 122 and MFN, Chinese goods face effective rates of 27-72%+ depending on the product.

All other countries are equal. Vietnam, India, Thailand, EU, Japan, and most other countries face identical tariff structures: MFN + 15% Section 122. The difference is only in MFN rates, which depend on the product, not the country.

Tariff Rates by Product Category

Category	MFN Rate	From China	From Vietnam	From Mexico (USMCA)
Electronics	2.5%	42.5%	17.5%	2.5%
Clothing	18%	58%	33%	18%
Footwear	15%	55%	30%	15%
Kitchen/Home	4%	44%	19%	4%
Toys	3%	43%	18%	3%
Beauty	4%	44%	19%	4%
Sports	5%	45%	20%	5%
Furniture	3%	43%	18%	3%
Pet Supplies	4%	44%	19%	4%
Food/Agriculture	8%	48%	23%	8%

The China vs. Vietnam Gap: For every product category, switching from China to Vietnam saves 25 percentage points in tariffs. On a \$100,000 shipment, that is \$25,000 in savings. The math is clear: unless China offers a massive price advantage, alternative sourcing countries are almost always cheaper after tariffs.

How to Calculate Your Total Duty

Step 1: Determine Your Customs Value

Customs value = Product Cost + International Shipping + Insurance (CIF value). This is the base on which all duties are calculated. Do NOT include domestic freight, buying commissions, or post-importation costs.

Step 2: Identify Your Tariff Layers

Based on your product type and country of origin, determine which tariff programs apply. Most products face MFN + Section 122. Chinese products add Section 301. Steel, aluminum, and autos face Section 232 instead of Section 122.

Step 3: Calculate Each Layer

Each tariff layer is calculated as a percentage of the customs value. The layers are additive: Total Duty = Customs Value x (MFN Rate + S122 Rate + S301 Rate + S232 Rate).

Step 4: Add Processing Fees

Merchandise Processing Fee (MPF): 0.3464% of customs value, minimum \$31.67, maximum \$614.35. Harbor Maintenance Fee (HMF): 0.125% of customs value, no cap. These fees apply to all imports regardless of tariff programs.

Step 5: Add Broker and Other Fees

Customs broker fee: typically \$150-250 per entry. Bond premium: \$500-2,000 per year for a continuous bond. These are paid to your customs broker, not to CBP.

Example Calculation

Line Item	Calculation	Amount
Product Cost (FOB)	1,000 units x \$10	\$10,000
Shipping (Ocean Freight)	LCL rate	\$800

Insurance	0.5% of value	\$50
Customs Value (CIF)	Sum of above	\$10,850
MFN Duty (5%)	$\$10,850 \times 5\%$	\$543
Section 122 (15%)	$\$10,850 \times 15\%$	\$1,628
Section 301 (25% - China)	$\$10,850 \times 25\%$	\$2,713
MPF (0.3464%)	$\$10,850 \times 0.3464\%$	\$37.58
HMF (0.125%)	$\$10,850 \times 0.125\%$	\$13.56
Customs Broker Fee	Flat fee	\$175
TOTAL LANDED COST		\$15,960

In this example, tariffs and fees add \$5,110 (47%) to the product cost. The per-unit landed cost is \$15.96, not \$10.00.

Free Calculator: Run these calculations instantly at ustariffcalc.com. Select your country, product category, and enter your value to see the full breakdown.

Chapter 6

Landed Cost: The Only Number That Matters

Landed cost is the total price of your product once it has arrived at your warehouse and is ready to sell. It includes everything: product cost, shipping, insurance, all duties and tariffs, processing fees, broker fees, and domestic freight.

The single most common mistake importers make is confusing FOB price with total cost. Your supplier quotes \$5 per unit FOB. You calculate margins based on \$5. But your real cost after shipping, tariffs, and fees is \$8-9. Your 50% margin product is actually a 20% margin product.

What is Included in Landed Cost

- **Product cost** (FOB, EXW, or CIF depending on your Incoterm)
- **International shipping** (ocean freight, air freight, or courier)
- **Cargo insurance** (typically 0.5-1% of value)
- **All import duties** (MFN + S122 + S301 + S232 as applicable)
- **Processing fees** (MPF + HMF)
- **Customs broker fee** (\$150-250 per entry)
- **Domestic freight** (port to warehouse)
- **Customs bond premium** (amortized per shipment)

Rule of Thumb

Add 10-15% on top of your calculated landed cost as a contingency buffer for unexpected costs like demurrage, exam fees, and currency fluctuations. This prevents margin surprises.

Section 122 Expiration: What Happens July 24

Key Date: July 24, 2026. Section 122 tariffs expire automatically on this date. The President cannot extend them without Congressional authorization. This is a hard deadline written into the statute.

Section 122 has a maximum duration of 150 days and a maximum rate of 15%. Both limits were applied when the tariffs were imposed on February 24, 2026. No executive action can change these limits.

Three Scenarios for What Comes Next

Scenario A: Section 122 Expires With No Replacement

If nothing replaces Section 122, the 15% surcharge simply disappears. European goods would drop from approximately 20% to 5%. Vietnamese goods would drop from about 18% to 3%. This is the best case for importers but the least likely scenario, as the administration has made clear it intends to maintain tariff protection.

Scenario B: Expanded Section 301 Replaces Section 122

The administration launched Section 301 investigations in March 2026 targeting 16 economies. These investigations could result in country-specific tariffs replacing the flat 15% surcharge. This is the most likely scenario. Some countries may see rates lower than 15%, others higher.

Scenario C: Congress Extends Tariff Authority

Congress could pass legislation granting broader tariff authority or explicitly extending the surcharge. Several bills have been introduced but none have advanced significantly. Political dynamics make this uncertain.

What Importers Should Do Now

- Model both scenarios using the tariff calculator at ustariffcalc.com
- Consider accelerating orders to arrive before July 24 if you expect higher replacement rates

- Diversify your supply chain across multiple countries to reduce single-country risk
- Monitor USTR announcements in the Federal Register for updates

The De Minimis Revolution (and Its End)

The \$800 de minimis exemption allowed packages valued under \$800 to enter the US duty-free. This exemption fueled the rise of Chinese e-commerce platforms like Temu, Shein, and AliExpress, which shipped over 1.3 billion de minimis packages to the US in 2024 alone.

That exemption has been eliminated for Chinese goods. Every package from China, regardless of value, now faces import duties. A \$10 phone case, a \$30 dress, a \$200 electronics kit: all are now taxed.

Who is Affected

- **Consumers:** Orders from Temu, Shein, and AliExpress now cost 25-57% more after duties
- **Dropshippers:** The duty-free dropshipping model from China is broken
- **Small importers:** Even small sample orders face duties

De Minimis Status by Country

Country	De Minimis Status	Threshold
China	ELIMINATED	\$0 - all taxed
Hong Kong (China origin)	ELIMINATED	\$0 - all taxed
Vietnam	Still valid	\$800
India	Still valid	\$800
Japan	Still valid	\$800
EU Countries	Still valid	\$800
Mexico	Still valid	\$800
Canada	Still valid	\$800
All other countries	Still valid	\$800

Chapter 9

Amazon FBA and Tariffs: Survival Guide

If you sell on Amazon FBA and source products from overseas, tariffs are now one of the biggest factors in your profit margin. Most FBA calculators ignore tariffs. In 2026, that is a fatal mistake.

The Real FBA Profit Formula

Net Profit = Selling Price - Product Cost (FOB) - Shipping to US - Import Duties (Tariff) - Amazon Referral Fee (15%) - FBA Fulfillment Fee - PPC/Advertising - Other Costs (storage, returns)

The line most sellers miss is Import Duties. A \$5 product from China with 44% tariffs adds \$2.20 per unit. At 1,000 units per month, that is \$2,200 in monthly tariff costs that directly reduce your margin.

Margin Targets

- **30%+ margin:** Excellent. Room for PPC and competition
- **20-30% margin:** Healthy but tight. Monitor costs closely
- **10-20% margin:** Dangerous. One tariff increase could wipe you out
- **Under 10%:** Not viable. Exit the product or change sourcing

Free FBA Calculator: Calculate your real margin including tariffs at ustariffcalc.com/fba-profit-calculator.html

7 Strategies to Reduce Your Tariff Exposure

1. Source from Lower-Tariff Countries

Vietnam, India, Thailand, and Indonesia do not face Section 301 tariffs. While they have the 15% Section 122 surcharge, total rates are 15-25% lower than Chinese goods. Mexico under USMCA is even better with 0% Section 122.

2. Optimize Your HTS Classification

Similar products can have dramatically different duty rates. Work with a customs broker to ensure your products are classified under the most favorable legitimate HTS code.

3. Use USMCA to Your Advantage

If you source from Mexico or Canada, ensure your products qualify under USMCA rules of origin. Qualifying goods are exempt from the 15% Section 122 surcharge.

4. Explore Foreign Trade Zones (FTZs)

FTZs allow you to defer, reduce, or eliminate duties. Products can be stored, assembled, or manufactured in an FTZ before entering US commerce.

5. Apply for Duty Drawback

If you import goods and then re-export them (including as components of other products), you may qualify for a refund of up to 99% of duties paid.

6. Negotiate Better FOB Pricing

A lower FOB price reduces your customs value, which reduces your duty bill. Even small reductions compound across thousands of units.

7. Claim Your IEEPA Refund

If you paid IEEPA tariffs between April 2025 and February 2026, you may be entitled to a full refund through the CAPE system.

Country Sourcing: China vs Vietnam vs Mexico

Side-by-Side Comparison: \$10,000 Electronics Shipment

Cost Element	China	Vietnam	Mexico (USMCA)
Product Cost	\$10,000	\$10,500	\$11,500
Shipping	\$800	\$850	\$400
Insurance	\$100	\$100	\$50
Customs Value	\$10,900	\$11,450	\$11,950
MFN (2.5%)	\$273	\$286	\$299
Section 301 (25%)	\$2,725	\$0	\$0
Section 122 (15%)	\$1,635	\$1,718	\$0
Fees	\$628	\$628	\$628
TOTAL LANDED	\$16,161	\$14,082	\$12,877
Savings vs China	-	\$2,079 (13%)	\$3,284 (20%)

Even though product costs are higher in Vietnam (+5%) and Mexico (+15%), the tariff savings more than compensate. Mexico wins on total landed cost despite having the highest product price.

The China Plus One Strategy

Maintain your Chinese supplier while developing at least one alternative source. This is not about abandoning China. It is about reducing risk and creating tariff optionality. Start small: order one product from an alternative supplier while keeping your Chinese supply chain. Compare quality, lead times, and total landed costs. Gradually shift volume where the economics work.

IEEPA Tariff Refunds: Get Your Money Back

If you paid IEEPA tariffs between April 2, 2025 and February 20, 2026, you may be entitled to a full refund. The Supreme Court ruling invalidated these tariffs, and CBP has established the CAPE system to process refund claims.

Who Qualifies

You qualify if you are the importer of record and paid any of the following: reciprocal tariffs (10-145% country-specific rates imposed under IEEPA), or fentanyl tariffs (25% on Canadian and Mexican goods under IEEPA). Section 301, Section 232, and Section 122 tariffs are NOT eligible for refunds.

How to Apply

- **Step 1:** Register for the CAPE system at the CBP website
- **Step 2:** Submit a refund declaration listing all eligible entries
- **Step 3:** Identify eligible entries (unliquidated or within 180 days of liquidation)
- **Step 4:** Wait 60-90 days for processing

Pro Tip: File the CAPE application AND a CBP protest AND consider a Court of International Trade lawsuit simultaneously. The refund landscape is still evolving, and having multiple claims protects your position.

Key Dates and Deadlines

Date	Event	Impact
Feb 20, 2026	SCOTUS strikes down IEEPA tariffs	Reciprocal tariffs invalidated
Feb 24, 2026	Section 122 imposed (15%)	Global surcharge begins
Mar 2026	Section 301 investigations launched	16 countries targeted
Jul 24, 2026	Section 122 EXPIRES	15% surcharge ends
Late 2026	New Section 301 tariffs (expected)	Country-specific rates

Appendix B

Glossary of Trade Terms

CBP

US Customs and Border Protection. The federal agency that collects duties and enforces trade laws.

CIF

Cost, Insurance, and Freight. The total value of goods including product cost, insurance, and shipping to the US port. This is typically the customs value.

De Minimis

The value threshold below which imports enter duty-free. Currently \$800 for most countries, eliminated for China.

FOB

Free on Board. The product price at the port of export. Does not include international shipping or insurance.

HMF

Harbor Maintenance Fee. 0.125% of customs value, charged on all imports through US ports.

HTS

Harmonized Tariff Schedule. The classification system that assigns a 10-digit code and duty rate to every product.

Landed Cost

The total cost of a product delivered to your warehouse, including all duties, fees, and shipping.

MFN

Most Favored Nation. The baseline tariff rate applied to imports from all WTO member countries.

MPF

Merchandise Processing Fee. 0.3464% of customs value, minimum \$31.67, maximum \$614.35.

Section 122

Trade Act of 1974 provision allowing temporary tariffs of up to 15% for 150 days.

Section 232

Trade Expansion Act provision for tariffs on goods threatening national security (steel, aluminum, autos).

Section 301

Trade Act of 1974 provision for tariffs responding to unfair trade practices (primarily used against China).

USMCA

United States-Mexico-Canada Agreement. Trade agreement that exempts qualifying goods from Section 122.

USTR

Office of the United States Trade Representative. The agency responsible for US trade policy.

Resources and Tools

Free Calculators

- **US Import Tariff Calculator:** ustariffcalc.com
- **FBA Profit Calculator:** ustariffcalc.com/fba-profit-calculator.html
- **Landed Cost Calculator:** ustariffcalc.com/landed-cost-calculator.html
- **Country Comparison:** ustariffcalc.com/tariff-comparison-calculator.html
- **De Minimis Calculator:** ustariffcalc.com/de-minimis-calculator.html

Official Government Resources

- **HTS Tariff Database:** hts.usitc.gov
- **CBP (Customs):** cbp.gov
- **USTR (Trade Representative):** ustr.gov
- **Federal Register:** federalregister.gov

Recommended Tools

- **Helium 10:** Product research for Amazon FBA sellers - helium10.com
- **Easyship:** Shipping and duty calculation platform - easyship.com

Thank you for reading the 2026 US Import Tariff Guide.

For the latest rates and calculations, visit ustariffcalc.com

Questions? contact@ustariffcalc.com